

Allied Tank Destroyers

There was a clear difference in design between Soviet and US tank destroyers and assault guns. The Soviets favored turretless vehicles for the same reasons as the Germans: they were quicker and cheaper to build, and could mount a larger gun and heavier armor than the tank they were based on. American tank destroyers, meanwhile, were intended to be used in counterattacks, outmaneuvering enemy tanks; they emphasized mobility over protection, and kept the more versatile turret. In reality, both countries used them as artillery pieces and to support infantry.

▷ M10
Date 1942 Country USA
Weight 32.5 tons (29.5 tonnes)
Engine General Motors 6046 diesel, 375 hp
Main armament 3in M7 L/40 gun

The M10 was based on the M4A2 Sherman chassis, and the M10A1 used the gasoline-engined M4A3, easing logistics. Both were lightly armored with an open-topped turret to enhance mobility and situational awareness. Around 6,500 were built. Many vehicles supplied to the UK were later upgunned with the 17-pounder, renamed the Achilles.



Main gun muzzle brake

△ SU-76M
Date 1943 Country Soviet Union
Weight 11.4 tons (10.4 tonnes)
Engine 2 x GAZ-203 6 cylinder diesel, 85 hp each
Main armament 76.2 mm ZiS-3Sh L/42.6 gun

With over 12,600 built, the SU-76M was the second most-produced Soviet armored vehicle of the war. Based on a stretched T-70 light tank chassis, it was used as a light assault gun and mobile artillery piece, and had the capability to destroy lighter German tanks. Although reliable and popular with the infantry, due to its light armor and open top its crew did not always feel the same.

Rubber-rimmed road wheels



122 mm howitzer

◁ SU-122
Date 1943 Country Soviet Union
Weight 34 tons (30.9 tonnes)
Engine Kharkiv Model V-2-34 diesel, 500 hp
Main armament 122 mm M-30S L/23 howitzer

Classified as a medium assault gun, the SU-122 was built on the T-34 chassis. It mounted a direct fire weapon mainly intended for use against fortifications. Its firepower and armor made the SU-122 a popular infantry support weapon. Around 1,100 were built. The upgraded SU-85 tank destroyer used the same design armed with an 85 mm D-5S gun.